

attractive. orkut actively encourages this by its hot list or crush list section where members can also send a teaser to the member they find attractive. Another motivating factor for these social networks is that they are a new means of socializing and building a new community of people on moving to a new city; social networking sites make it easier to join and connect to new people or communities within a similar geographical area, and to share common interests and join various urban tribes.

Members of sites are eager to sign up and increase their visibility within a network, and to get as many people to join their network making themselves look popular and important. The more connections a person has, the bigger their network is even if the connections are weak ties. orkut presents its members with large networks as connectors, celebrities and stars depending on the number of profile views, average paths and fan counts each member has. However the presence or over exposure on these sites can also at times equate to a popularity contest based on status of how many friends or friends of friends one has. Not surprisingly the term “friendster whore” [a]has surfaced -meaning people who collect as many people as possible for no other reason as to increase the size of their network. People are also motivated to search for interesting members on the site and to add these people as their friends. There is also actually a tribe on Tribe.net called Friendster Whores.

2 Classification

2.1 Registration-Based vs. Connection Based

The majority of social networking sites have no restrictions as to who can join or when. These sites are registration based, where a person simply fills out a form of required details such as name, location, e-mail address and desired password. Registration for most sites is not subject to approval or moderation by another user, but usually does require some confirmation of details by clicking an activation link sent to the e-mail address entered. Once an account is activated, a user can begin adding friends to their